

Instantiated on new datasets, the conservative gate fusion adds value when branch and expert are matched (IEMOCAP, +0.8 pp over 3 seeds), and degrades gracefully when they are not

Left: test WF1, mean $\pm$ SD over 3 seeds, fixed- α gate (α from valid) · Right: gain vs input-strength gap (branch vs strongest expert), same protocol · M3ED point from the frozen formal test · expert arm has no seed variance (single checkpoint)

